

United States History and Geography — Teacher Key

United States History and Geography · Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28 · Form FORM-B

TEACHER COPY — contains answer keys and rationales. Not for student distribution.

classroom-formative · pre-field-test. Item parameters are estimates and have not met a student; this form is not a calibrated instrument. This is a selected-response form. It assesses Depth of Knowledge levels 1 through 3. It carries no extended-response item, so it does not assess DOK-4 — a four-option question cannot ask a student to construct and defend an argument. Extended responses and document-based questions are delivered as separate activities.

1. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the signing ceremony for the North Atlantic Treaty on April 4, 1949. The treaty created the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO), a mutual defense alliance between the United States, Canada, and ten Western European nations. (Photograph, April 4, 1949. Public Domain.) What was the PRIMARY purpose of the alliance created by the treaty shown being signed in this photograph?

- A. To establish free trade among Western nations
- B. To create a unified European government
- C. To dismantle colonial empires in Asia and Africa
- D. To provide collective defense against Soviet aggression in Europe

KEY: D · DOK 1 · US.59

Why the key is right: NATO was created as a collective defense alliance against the Soviet threat. Article 5 established that an attack on one member would be considered an attack on all. This was a historic break from American tradition — the first peacetime military alliance since the founding of the republic.

A — Free trade among Western nations came through separate economic instruments — the Marshall Plan and later the OEEC. NATO's founding treaty is a mutual-defence pact.

B — No political union was created. Each member kept full sovereignty; NATO commits members to respond to an attack, not to govern jointly.

C — Several founding members were themselves colonial powers in 1949. Decolonisation was not a NATO aim and in places ran against member interests.

Item analysis

Standard

US.59 — Describe the competition between the United States and the Soviet Union in arms development, economic dominance, and ideology, including the roles of the United Nations, NATO, and the Warsaw Pact.

DOK / Hess

Level 1 — The student recalls the stated purpose of a named treaty organisation. One retrieved fact, which is DOK-1; explaining why a peacetime alliance broke with American tradition would be DOK-2.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.0 · b -1.2 · c 0.22 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

required, not yet done

Distractor diagnosis

A — confuses NATO's military purpose with postwar economic cooperation; **B** — reads a defensive alliance as a step toward European political union; **C** — attributes decolonisation aims to an alliance of colonial powers

2. What was the satellite state system in Eastern Europe?

- A. Eastern European countries controlled by the Soviet Union after World War II
- B. Independent nations that voluntarily formed economic partnerships with the USSR
- C. Asian countries that cooperated on space technology with the Soviet program
- D. Western European nations that received economic aid from the United States

KEY: A · DOK 1 · US.59

Why the key is right: The satellite state system in Eastern Europe was Eastern European countries controlled by the Soviet Union after World War II. Choice C is wrong because it describes asian countries that cooperated on space technology with the Soviet program, not eastern European countries controlled by the Soviet Union after World War II. These developments defined the Cold War as a global struggle over power, ideology, and influence.

B — Participation was not voluntary. Soviet troops remained after 1945 and coalition governments were replaced by communist ones, as in Czechoslovakia in 1948.

C — The word 'satellite' here is political, not orbital — it describes a state held in another's orbit of control, and predates the space programme.

D — Nations receiving American aid were the Marshall Plan recipients in Western Europe — the opposite bloc.

Item analysis

Standard

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DOK / Hess

Level 1 — The student recalls what a named term denoted. A single retrieved definition, which is DOK-1.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 0.48 · b -1.0 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

required, not yet done

Distractor diagnosis

B — mistakes imposed control for voluntary partnership; **C** — reads 'satellite state' as a reference to spaceflight; **D** — reverses which bloc the satellite states belonged to

3. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the NATO treaty signing, April 4, 1949. (Photograph, 1949. Public Domain.) How did the creation of NATO, shown in this photograph, represent a departure from traditional American foreign policy?

- A. NATO was a temporary agreement that expired after five years
- B. It was the first peacetime military alliance in American history
- C. The alliance required no military commitment from the United States
- D. The United States had long maintained peacetime military alliances in Europe

KEY: B · DOK 2 · US.59

Why the key is right: Since Washington's Farewell Address warned against 'permanent alliances,' the United States had avoided binding military commitments to European nations. NATO represented a fundamental break: a permanent peacetime alliance committing the U.S. to defend Western Europe. This reflected the Cold War reality that isolationism was no longer viable against the Soviet threat.

A — The treaty carried no expiry. It has been in continuous force since 1949 and has expanded well beyond its original members.

C — Article 5 is precisely a military commitment: an attack on one is treated as an attack on all. That obligation is what made the treaty historically significant.

D — The opposite: Washington's Farewell Address warned against permanent alliances, and the United States had avoided them in peacetime for over 150 years.

Item analysis

Standard

US.59 — Describe the competition between the United States and the Soviet Union in arms development, economic dominance, and ideology, including the roles of the United Nations, NATO, and the Warsaw Pact.

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — The student must connect the fact of the treaty to what it broke with in American practice — a relationship between an event and a tradition, which is DOK-2. Naming the year or the members would be DOK-1.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.3 · b 0.1 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

required, not yet done

Distractor diagnosis

A — invents a time limit the treaty does not contain; **C** — empties the alliance of the mutual-defence obligation that defines it; **D** — reverses the American tradition NATO broke with

4. How did the formation of NATO and the Warsaw Pact reflect the ideological competition between the United States and the Soviet Union during the Cold War?

- A. The alliances reflected agreement between superpowers on the need for collective disarmament
- B. Both alliances were formed primarily for economic cooperation rather than military defense
- C. They split Europe into rival military blocs, one capitalist and one communist
- D. NATO and the Warsaw Pact were created jointly to prevent a third world war between smaller nations

KEY: C · DOK 2 · US.59

Why the key is right: NATO (1949) aligned Western democracies under U.S. leadership; the Warsaw Pact (1955) formalized Soviet bloc military cooperation, institutionalizing the ideological divide across Europe.

A — Disarmament is the reverse of what followed. Both blocs expanded conventional and nuclear forces through the 1950s and 1960s.

B — Both were defence pacts. The economic instruments of the period were separate: the Marshall Plan on one side, COMECON on the other.

D — They were not created jointly and not at the same time. NATO came in 1949 and the Warsaw Pact in 1955, formed in response to it.

Item analysis

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DOK / Hess

Level 2 — The student must read two alliance systems as expressions of an ideological contest — inferring a pattern from paired events, which is DOK-2.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.2 · b -0.2 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

required, not yet done

Distractor diagnosis

A — reads an arms build-up as an agreement to disarm; **B** — confuses the military alliances with the parallel economic blocs; **D** — treats two opposing alliances as a cooperative project

5. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows a U.S. Air Force C-54 Skymaster cargo plane flying low over a crowd of German civilians as it approaches Tempelhof Airport in Berlin during the summer of 1948. (Photograph, 1948. U.S. Air Force.) To what extent did early Cold War confrontations like the one shown in this photograph shape the formation of military alliances in Europe?

- A. The crisis led both the U.S. and Soviet Union to immediately reduce their military presence in Europe
- B. The crisis had no lasting impact because the Soviet Union voluntarily ended the blockade
- C. The crisis was resolved through the United Nations, proving that international organizations alone could maintain peace
- D. The crisis accelerated the creation of NATO as Western nations sought collective security against Soviet aggression

KEY: D · DOK 3 · US.59

Why the key is right: The Berlin Blockade and Airlift convinced Western nations that a formal military alliance was necessary for collective defense against Soviet expansionism, directly contributing to the establishment of NATO in April 1949.

Item analysis

Standard

US.59 — Describe the competition between the United States and the Soviet Union in arms development, economic dominance, and ideology, including the roles of the United Nations, NATO, and the Warsaw Pact.

DOK / Hess

Level 3 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.6 · b 0.7 · c 0.18 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

6. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the NATO treaty signing, 1949. (Photograph, 1949. Public Domain.) Analyze how NATO fit into the broader containment strategy of the United States during the early Cold War.

- A. NATO was the military component of containment — complementing the Truman Doctrine's political commitment and the Marshall Plan's economic support to prevent Soviet expansion into Western Europe
- B. NATO was unrelated to containment and was created solely for economic cooperation
- C. NATO replaced the containment policy with a strategy of direct military confrontation with the Soviet Union
- D. The containment strategy relied entirely on nuclear weapons and did not include alliances

KEY: A · DOK 3 · US.59

Why the key is right: NATO was one pillar of a comprehensive containment architecture: the Truman Doctrine (1947) committed the U.S. to supporting nations resisting communism; the Marshall Plan (1948) rebuilt Western European economies to resist communist appeal; NATO (1949) provided the military guarantee that the U.S. would defend Europe. Together, these policies created an interlocking system that defined Cold War strategy for decades.

Item analysis

Standard

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DOK / Hess

Level 3 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.7 · b 1.0 · c 0.17 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis